MILITARY SPECIFICATION

GLOVES, SURGEONS', STERILE, DISPOSABLE, BROWN, MILLED

This specification is approved for use by Defense Personnel Support Center, Defense Logistics Agency, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers sterile, disposable, surgeons' brown, milled rubber gloves, suitable for use in performing physical examination and surgical procedures.

1.2 Classification. Gloves shall be of the size specified for the appropriate stock number and item identification (see 3.3 and 6.2).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENT

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-566	- Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	- Boxes, Set-up, Paperboard.

MILITARY

MIL-S-36586	- Sterilization Test Strip Set, Bacterial Spore.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should eb addressed to: Hq, Defense Personnel Support Center, ATTN: Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-ATT, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 6515

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STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED. TEST METHOD STD. NO. 601 - Rubber: Sampling and Testing.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications, standards, and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained form the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply.

U. S. PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION, INC.

The United States Pharmacopeia (USP).

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Gloves. The gloves shall be fabricated from brown, milled natural rubber.

3.1.2 Dusting powder. Powder shall comply with the USP requirements for Absorbable Dusting Powder.

3.2 Style and design. The gloves shall be supplied as a matching pair (conventional left and right hand), sterile, and suitable for performing physical examinations and surgical procedures. The gloves shall be constructed to facilitate maximum tactility in use, and shall have straight or curved, well-fitting fingers that permit maximum freedom of movement. The palm section shall be of sufficient width to permit comfortable flexing of the hands. The wrists shall be tapered and shall have a bead roll

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to minimize "roll down". The gloves shall be uniformly prepowdered with dusting powder. A minimum amount of powder is preferred. The gloves shall be supplied in a folded inner wrapper which in turn shall be enclosed in an outer wrapper as specified in 3.4. The gloves shall be placed flat, without rolling or folding, except that the wrist portion shall be folded inside out over the palm. The inner wrapper shall be of sufficient size to permit flat placement of the gloves and shall completely cover and separate both gloves. The gloves shall be packaged in such a manner as to permit ready identification of the left and right hand glove, and permit ready dispensing of the gloves by sterile technique.

3.3 Dimensions and weight. Dimensions shall be measured as specified in 4.5.1. The gloves shall range in thickness from 0.004 to 0.012 inch. Other dimensions and weights of the gloves shall be as indicated in table I.

TABLE I. Dimensions and weights.

Size	Length 1/ (inches minimum)	Circumference of palm 2/ (inches, 1/8 + 1/4)	Weight per dozen pair (oz., min.)
6	10	6	6
6-1/2	10	6-1/2	6-1/2
7	10	7	6-3/4
7-1/2	10	7-1/2	7
8	10	8	7-1/2
8-1/2	10	8-1/2	8
9	10	9	8-1/2

1/ Measured from the tip of the middle finger to the end of the gauntlet.

2/ Measured at a level between the base of the index finger and the thumb.

3.4 Individual package. The completed, individual package shall consist of a pair of gloves in an inner wrapper or paperboard wallet enclosed in turn in an outer sealed wrapper. The outer wrapper shall maintain the sterility of the inner packaging and its contents. Outer wrapper shall permit ready dispensing of the contents by sterile techniques. Closure of the outer wrapper shall be accomplished by cold sealing. The sealed outer wrapper shall be designed to strip cleanly, without leaving jagged edges of paper extending into the sterilized field more than 5/16 inch, or otherwise contaminating the contents.

3.5 Physical requirements. The gloves shall comply with the physical requirements container table II. Tests shall be conducted as specified in 4.5.2.

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TABLE II. Physical requirements.

Characteristics	Values
Tensile stress at 500 percent elongation	1000 pounds per square inch, maximum
Tensile strength	2500 pounds per square inch, minimum
Ultimate elongation	650 percent, minimum
Accelerated aging	
Tensile strength	70 percent of original, minimum
Ultimate elongation	70 percent of original, minimum

3.6 Sterility and maintenance of sterility requirements. The completed individual package, consisting of a pair of gloves enclosed in an inner wrapper, which in turn is enclosed in a sealed outer wrapper, shall be sterilized. The outer wrapper shall then maintain the sterility of its contents. The entire unit shall then comply with the requirements contained in the following paragraphs:

3.6.1 Deterioration. After sterilizing, the prepowdered gloves and the inner and outer wrappers shall show no visual signs of deterioration or other detrimental effects. Discoloration of the wrapper shall not be considered as deterioration. The markings on the gloves (see 3.8.1) shall remain legible and shall not rub off.

3.6.2 Freedom from pinholes. The gloves shall be free of pinholes when tested in accordance with 4.5.5.

3.6.3 Sterility. The entire contents of the outer wrapper shall be sterile. The gloves shall comply with requirements for sterility as specified in 4.5.3.

3.6.3.1 Certificate of sterility. A certificate of sterility, stating that samples from each sterilizer lot have been tested and found to be sterile, shall be submitted to the procuring activity. The certificate of sterility shall include:

a. Item identification.
b. National Stock Number (NSN).
c. Contract or purchase order number.
d. Sterility lot or control number.
e. Date of sterilization.
f. Quantity of product in sterilizer lot.
g. Type of sterilization (gas, radiation, heat, steam, etc.).
h. Form of biological indicator (i.e., inoculated paper spore strip or carrier, inoculated product, or inoculated simulated product).

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i. Test organism(s) and population density used.
j. Test medium, inculbation temperature, incubation time, and dates of tests.
k. Number of test units.
l. Statement that samples comply with sterility tests.
m. Signature of head of laboratory or a designated qualified alternate.

When inspection is made at destination, the certificate of sterility shall be submitted by the contractor to the Directorate of Medical Materiel, ATTN: DPSC-ATQ, Defense Personnel Support Center, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, and a copy forwarded with each shipment to the consignee. When inspection is made at source, certificate of sterility shall be furnished to the cognizant Government Quality Assurance Representative for submission to the procuring activity.

3.6.3.2 Sterility lot. A sterility lot is that single quantity of product subjected to the same manufacturing operation and sterilized simultaneously in the same sterilizer chamber. Each unit package shall be clearly marked with a sterility lot (control) number and date of sterilization as specified in 5.3.2. Each sterility lot shall be traceable to the pertinent manufacturing lot(s).

3.6.4 Dispensability. The outer wrapper of the sterile, completed unit shall be capable of being opened without endangering the sterility of its contents when tested as in 4.5.4.

3.7 Finish. The gloves shall have a uniform smooth finish free from holes, visible ingrained particles, tackiness, strings, and other imperfections.

3.8 Identification.

3.8.1 Gloves. The gloves shall be legibly and permanently marked with the appropriate size and name or registered trademark of the contractor.

3.8.2 Outer wrapper. The outer wrapper shall be labeled or marked to identify the contents to include the glove size, name of contractor, instructions for opening (see 3.9), and the legend "STERILE". The outer wrapper may be marked with the legend "DISPOSABLE" or "SINGLE USE". The outer wrapper shall have the following imprinted on it in letters 1/8 inch or more in height: "Powder should be removed from the gloves after donning by wiping the gloves thoroughly with a sterile wet sponge, sterile wet towel, or other effective method."

3.9 Instructions. Each outer wrapper shall be marked with instructions describing the proper technique for dispensing the sterile contents from the outer wrapper without compromising the sterility of the contents.

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3.10 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Gloves shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability. Gloves shall be packed under patently sanitary conditions, and there shall be no indication of soil or any foreign material on them or in the envelope (outer wrapper).

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Repsonsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the contractor may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in table III. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one glove.

TABLE III. Sampling criteria for examination.

Type of defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	S-4	1.0
Minor	S-4	2.5

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4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in table IV. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one glove. Where possible, the same sample unit shall be used for determination of two or more test characteristics.

TABLE IV. Sampling criteria for tests.

Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Dispensability	3.2, 3.6.4 and 3.9	4.5.4	S-1	1.0
Dimensions and weight	3.3 and Table I	4.5.1	S-1	1.0
Physicals	3.5	4.5.2 and Table VI	S-2	1.0
Freedom from pinholes	3.6.2	4.5.5	S-2	1.0
Sterility	3.6.3	4.5.3	S-3	0.40

4.3 Examination. The gloves shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification. Visual examination shall include inflation of the gloves to be examined. This inflation shall be limited to 350 ± 50 percent elongation on any part of the glove. Examination shall be conducted as specified in tables III and V. Examination however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in tables III and V. Any glove in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected (defective) and if the number of defective gloves in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

TABLE V. Classification of defects.

Categories	Defects
Critical	None defined.
Major	
101	Tears, large holes.
102	Large open blisters.
103	Imbedded particles.
104	Caution notice missing (see 3.8.2).
105	Tackiness.
106	No inner wrapper included.
107	Gloves in inner wrapper doubled over upon themselves.

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TABLE V. Classification of defects - continued.

Categories	Defects
Minor	
201	Excessive blisters that would interfere with accepted professional use (clusters of small blisters as contrasted with large open blisters).
202	Snapback, bloom strings, bleeding, or other imperfections.
203	Excessive amounts of dusting powder.

4.4 Packaging inspection. The inspection of the unit package, packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

4.5 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. All samples or test specimens intended for accelerated aging tests shall be protected from any unnecessary exposure to strong light prior to the aging. The samples and specimens shall be kept in light-tight containers, except while being inspected, prepared or measured.

4.5.1 Dimensions. Dimensions shall be measured in accordance with the test method of FED. TEST METHOD Std. No. 601, indicated in table VI.

4.5.2 Physical requirements. Physical requirements tests shall be conducted in accordance with the test methods of FED. TEST METHOD Std. No. 601 indicated in table VI.

TABLE VI. Test methods.

REQUIREMENT	TEST METHOD NO.
Thickness	2011 or 2031
Tensile stress	4131 *
Tensile strength	4111 *
Ultimate elongation	4121 *
Accelerated aging (oxygen pressure test)	7111 *

* Use dumbbell specimen cut with die III of Figure 4111.

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4.5.3 Sterility test. The gloves shall be tested for sterility in accordance with the method specified in the USP using inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). Product containing a biological indicator shall be marked or labeled so that it clearly differentiates from product intended for distribution. The incubation medium and minimum time in each case shall be soybean casein digest for 7 days for inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). The incubation temperature shall be as indicated in paragraph 4.5.3.1. The minimum number of test units, regardless of lot size, shall be 10, except for inoculated carrier which shall be 20 for Type I Sterilization and 30 for Type II Sterilization including inoculated carrier and product test units. The inspection level shall be as indicated in table IV.

4.5.3.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. For each type of sterilization, the organsim used shall be as listed below:

Type of Sterilization	Organism	Incubation Temperature
Steam	B. stearothermophilus	55° - 65°C
Dry Heat	B. stearothermophilus, or	55° - 65°C
	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Gas	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Radiation	B. pumilus	30° - 35°C

The number of viable cells shall be sufficient to provide assurance that the product has been sterilized.

4.5.3.2 Inoculated carrier. Inoculated carriers (paper spore strips) if used shall be in accordance with MIL-S-36586. Other paper carriers shall be inoculated to be of equivalent resistance. The method of incubation and number of test units shall be as indicated. The method of sterilization will control the one organism in the spore strip to be tested. NOTE: When an inoculated carrier is chosen, product samples must also be tested as required by the USP.

4.5.3.3 Alternate method. Suppliers conducting sterility tests or designating lots in a manner other than that indicated herein shall submit proof that the alternate method provides equal assurance concerning the sterility of the product. However, all sterility tests shall be conducted using biological indicators. Requests for approval of any alternate method of testing for sterility shall be made to the Contracting Officer, and approval obtained before employment of the alternate method on a government contract.

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4.5.3.4 Product testing. Testing for sterility of the product after receipt by the Government shall be without a biological indicator and in accordance with the USP.

4.5.4 Dispensability test. The outer wrapper shall be opened, and the gloves removed in accordance with instructions provided (see 3.6.4).

4.5.5 Pinhole test. The gloves shall be inflated to 20 ± 3mm mercury air pressure and viewed against a close background light equal in illumination to that of a 15-watt fluorescent tube.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One package containing fifty pair of gloves constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Level A.

5.1.2.1 Unit packaging.

5.1.2.1.1 Individual package. Each pair of gloves shall be packaged as specified in 3.2.2.

5.1.2.1.2 Unit package. Fifty individually packaged pairs of gloves of one size only shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-636, class domestic or PPP-B-676. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification. As an alternate, the unit package may be a snug fitting sealed, chipboard or paperboard dispenser type box of an appropriate design.

5.1.3 Level C. Each pair of gloves shall be packaged as specified in 3.2.2. Fifty individally packaged pairs of gloves shall be further packaged in a manner that will afford adequate protection against deterioration and physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Six unit packages shall be packed in a shipping container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, type CF, class weather-resistant. Closure, waterproofing and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Six unit packages shall be packed in a shipping container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

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5.2.3 Level C. The packaged gloves shall be packed in shipping containers in a manner that will afford adequate protection against damage during direct shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. These packs shall conform to the carrier's rules and regulations.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Individual packages. Each individual package shall be marked as specified in 3.8.

5.3.2 Unit package. Each unit package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Sterility lot number shall be shown. The method of sterilization (G-Gas, R-Radiation, C-Cold, S-Steam, D-Dry Heat) shall be shown following the level of preservation and date of packaging. Example: "A-9/77-G". Final sterilization shall be on or after indicated packaging date.

5.3.3 Shipping containers. Each shipping container shall be marked as specified in MIL-STD-129. Sterility lot number and the method of sterilization shall be shown.

6. NOTES

6.1 Dusting powder. There is increasing evidence that granulomatous conditions following operations may have been caused by the dusting powder. For this reason, surgeons follow the practice of removing the powder from the exterior of the gloves after donning and before operating by wiping thoroughly with a sterile wet sponge or sterile wet towel.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Applicable size (see 1.2 and 3.3).
c. Applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 National Stock Number coverage. This specification covers the following item listed in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6515-01-044-4155	GLOVES, SURGEONS', Sterile, Disposable, Brown, Milled, Rubber, Size 7½, 50 pairs,

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER (Number) AND TITLE MIL-G-37838(DLA-DM) GLOVES, SURGEONS', Sterile, Disposable, Brown, Milled, Rubber, Size 7½, 50 pairs

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